


Rajiv Memani, CEO, EY India & President, CII

Prashant Ruia, Chief Executive, Essar Group

130 |

spoke about India's economy, its scale and demand, infrastructure, supply chain importance and as a hub for talent. The shift is subtle, but visible. After all, when the established order is being broken up, you would back what looks resilient.

IKEA's boss Juvencio Maeztu put it in a way only a consumer business leader can. He said he was "emotionally biased" towards India, and described it as a long-term, "100-year" market. Then came the economist's version of the same argument. Gita Gopinath underlined India's growth story, while also offering a sharp warning: pollution is a bigger economic threat to India than tariffs.

On their part, each of the participating Indian states treated Davos like a compact, high-pressure marketplace. At the India Showcase organised by *Business Today*, Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu delivered the kind of line that resonates in boardrooms. He said he has changed the gear from "ease of doing business" to "speed of doing business."


Sanjeev Krishan, Chairperson, PwC in India

There was also a back story to Naidu being back in Davos. He was among the first Indian politicians to spot the opportunity the stage presented decades ago. He returned this year at a time when India itself is no longer a sidebar.

And yet, back home, some politics played out as usual. The Maharashtra government's memoranda of understanding (MoUs) at Davos with Mumbai-based companies


Yoshua Bengio Professor, University of Montreal

triggered some to ask, why fly to Switzerland to sign what can be signed in Mumbai?

The criticism misses the central point of Davos. It is not the location, but the concentration of so many global companies that are present in one location that helps deal-making. Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis defended the state's approach, pointing out that none of the MoUs signed at Davos